

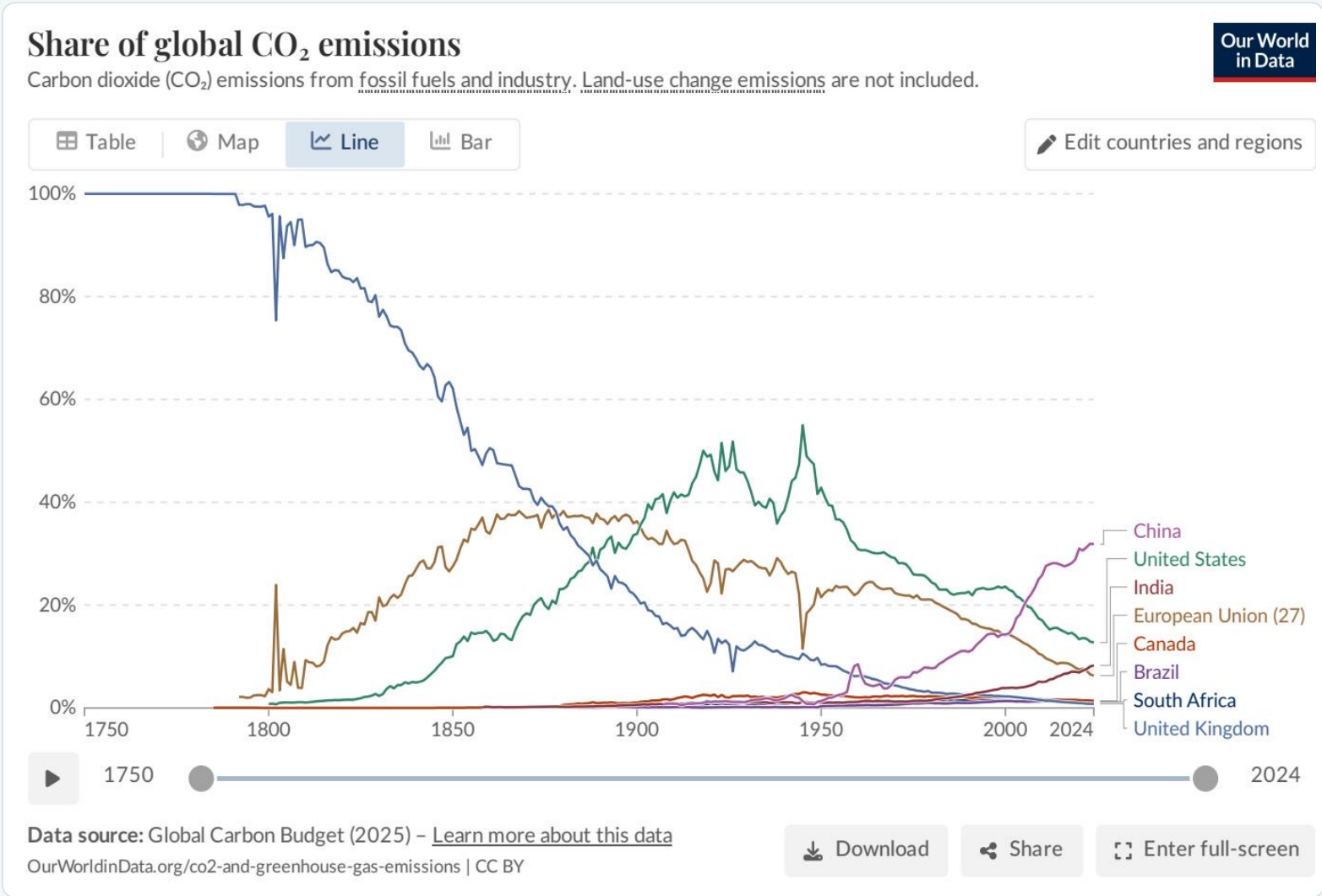
Global CO₂ Emissions: Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

A data-forward overview for policy analysts, climate negotiators, and sustainability researchers.

>35 Bt

annual global CO₂ emissions today

Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today



~6 Bt

world emissions by 1950

>20 Bt

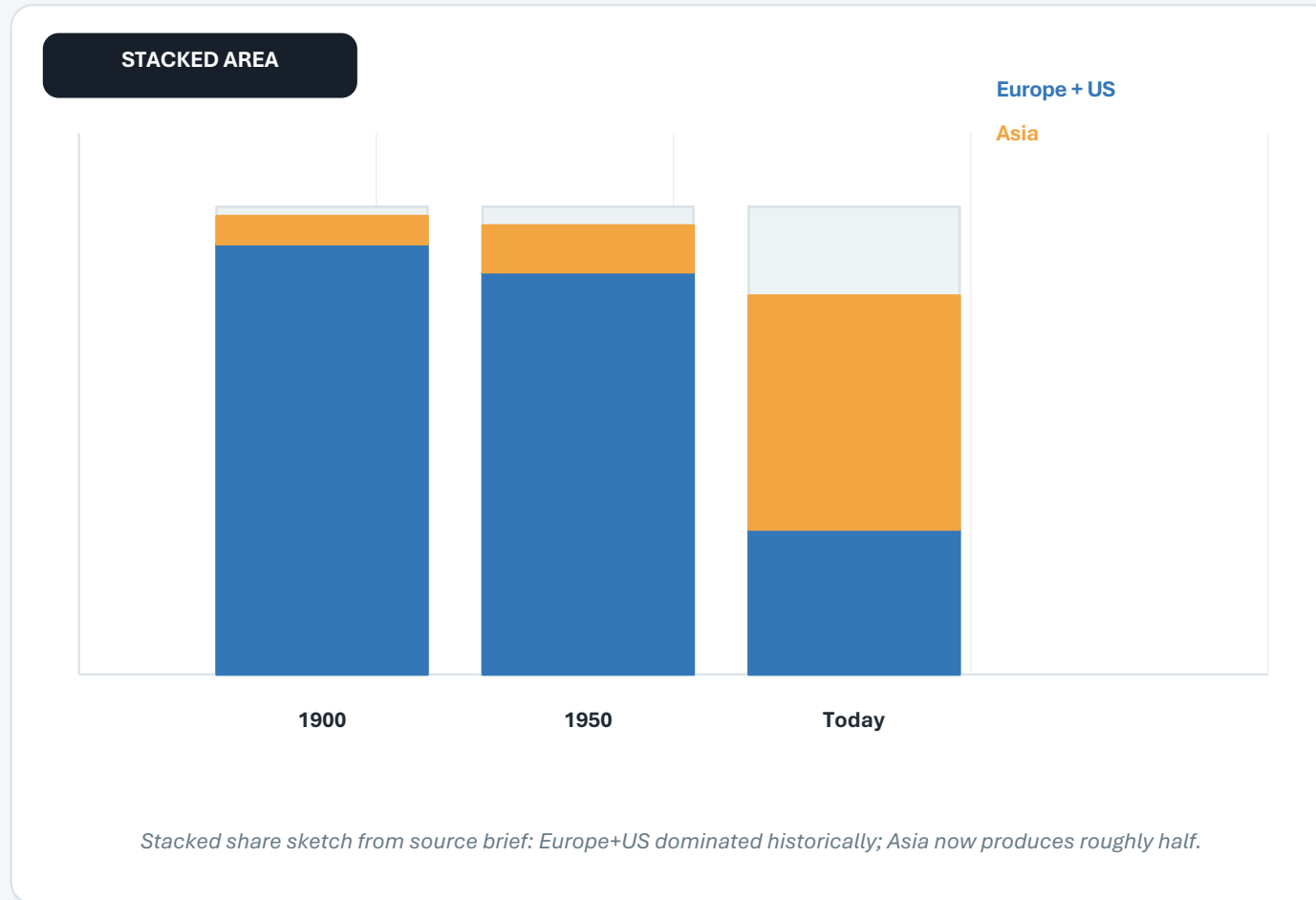
global emissions by 1990

>35 Bt

annual emissions today; growth has slowed, but no peak yet

Annotated source figure shows the long-run area/line trajectory: negligible pre-industrial emissions, post-1950 acceleration, and recent slowing without a peak.

Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today



>90%

Europe + United States share of global CO₂ in 1900

>85%

still represented by Europe + United States in 1950

<1/3

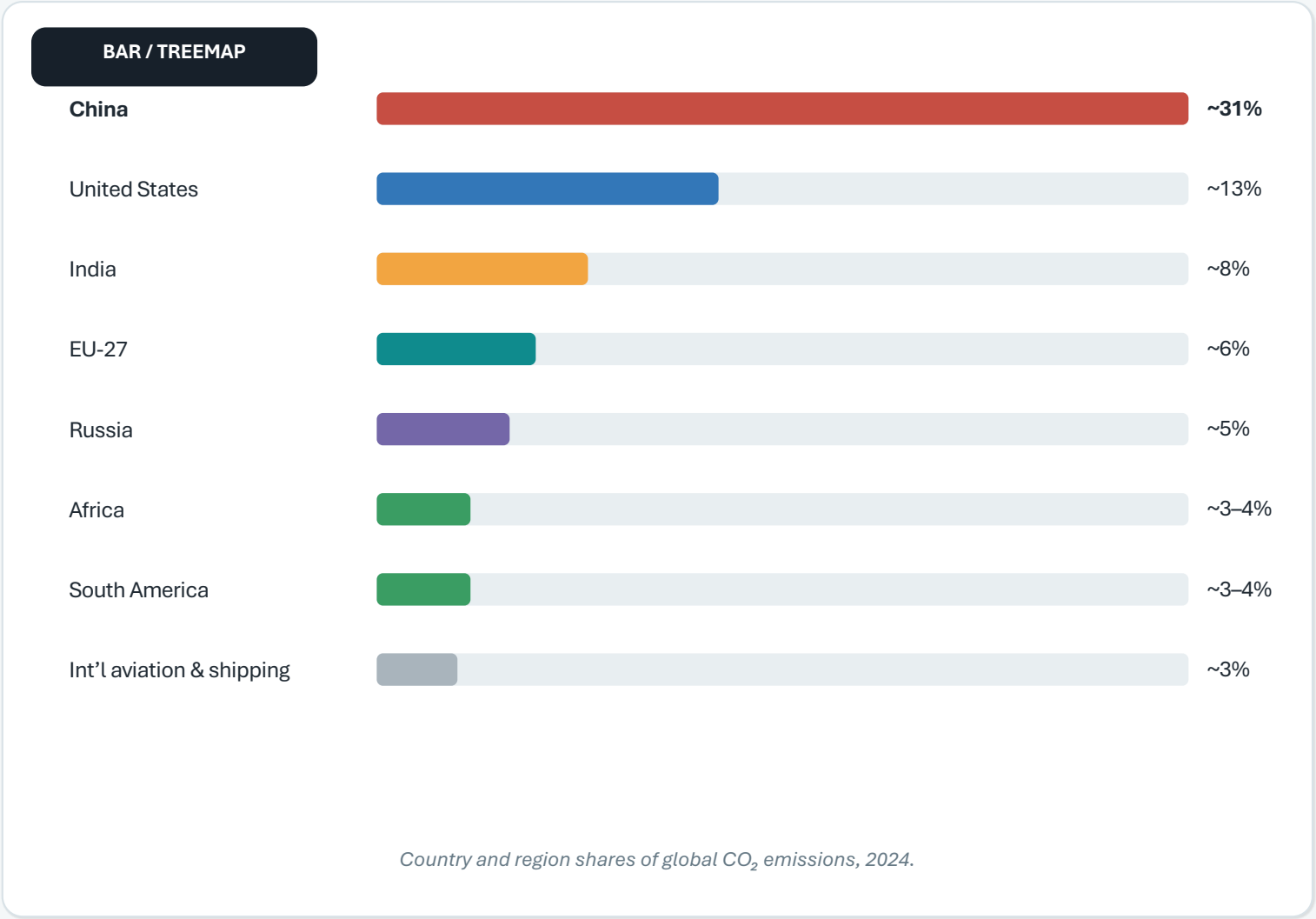
Europe + United States share today

~1/2

Asia's current share, led by China

- The center of annual emissions shifted from early industrializers toward Asia.
- Historical dominance and current shares point to different responsibility lenses.

China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂



~31%

China's approximate share of global CO₂ in 2024

~13%

United States share;
declining trend

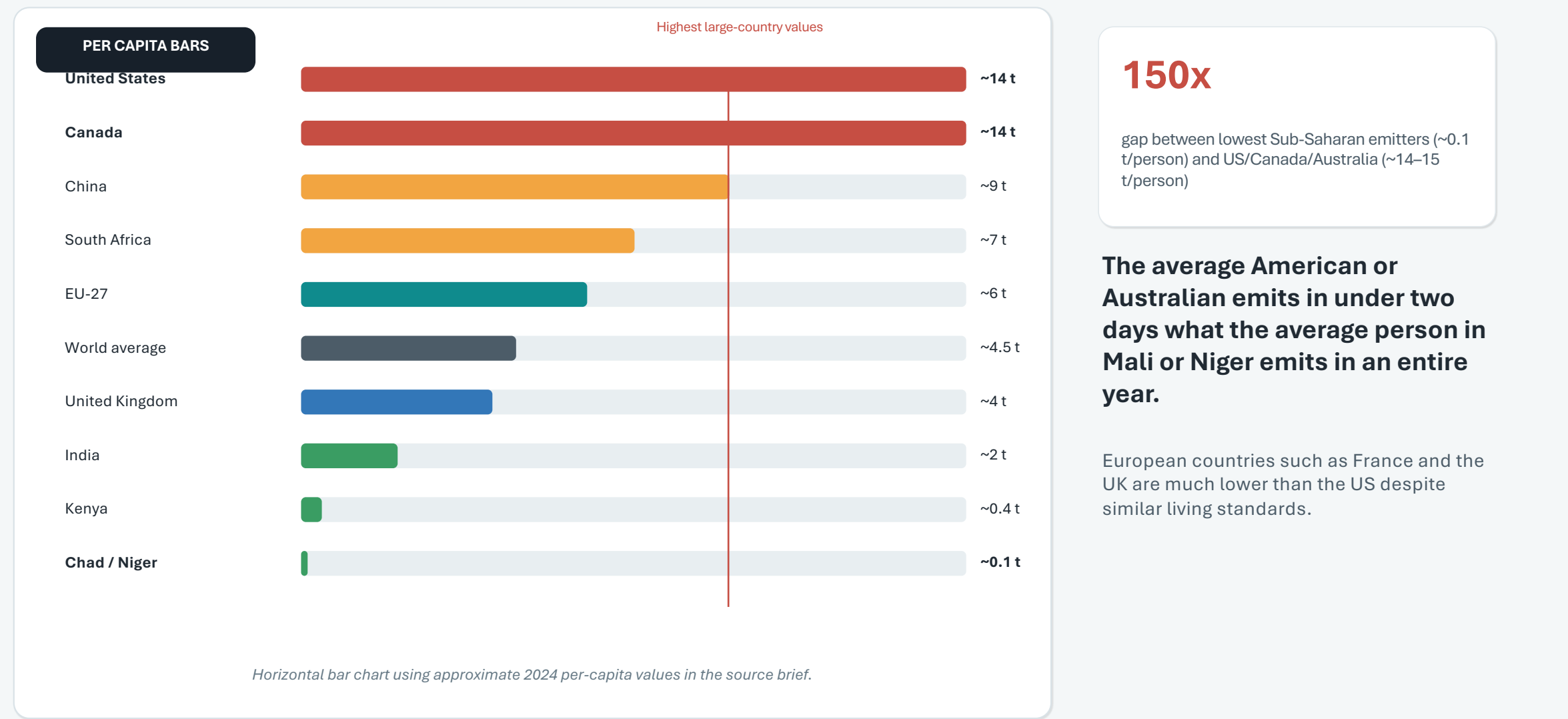
~8%

India share; rising
trend

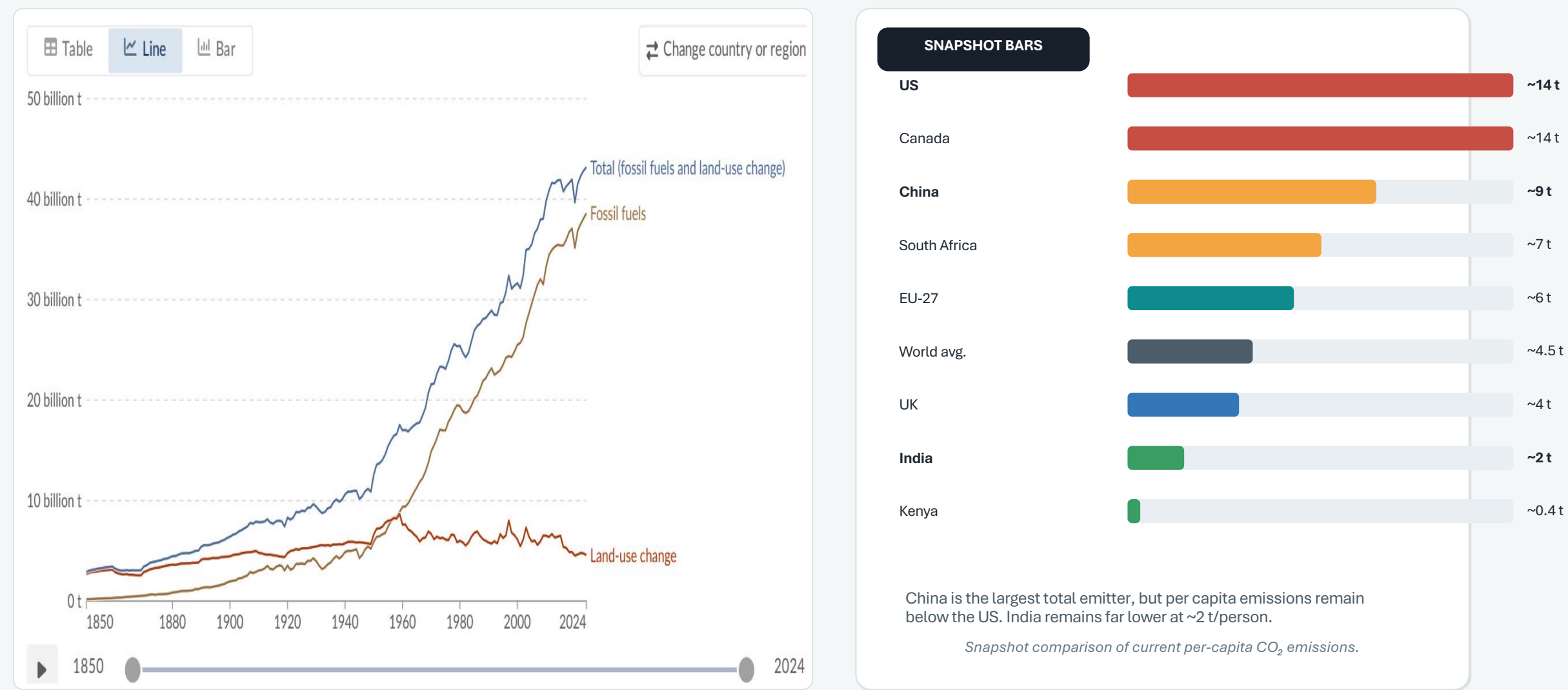
Africa and South America each account for only 3–4% — comparable to international aviation and shipping combined (~3%).

Trend direction from source table: China and India rising; United States and EU-27 declining; Russia and South America roughly stable.

Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada



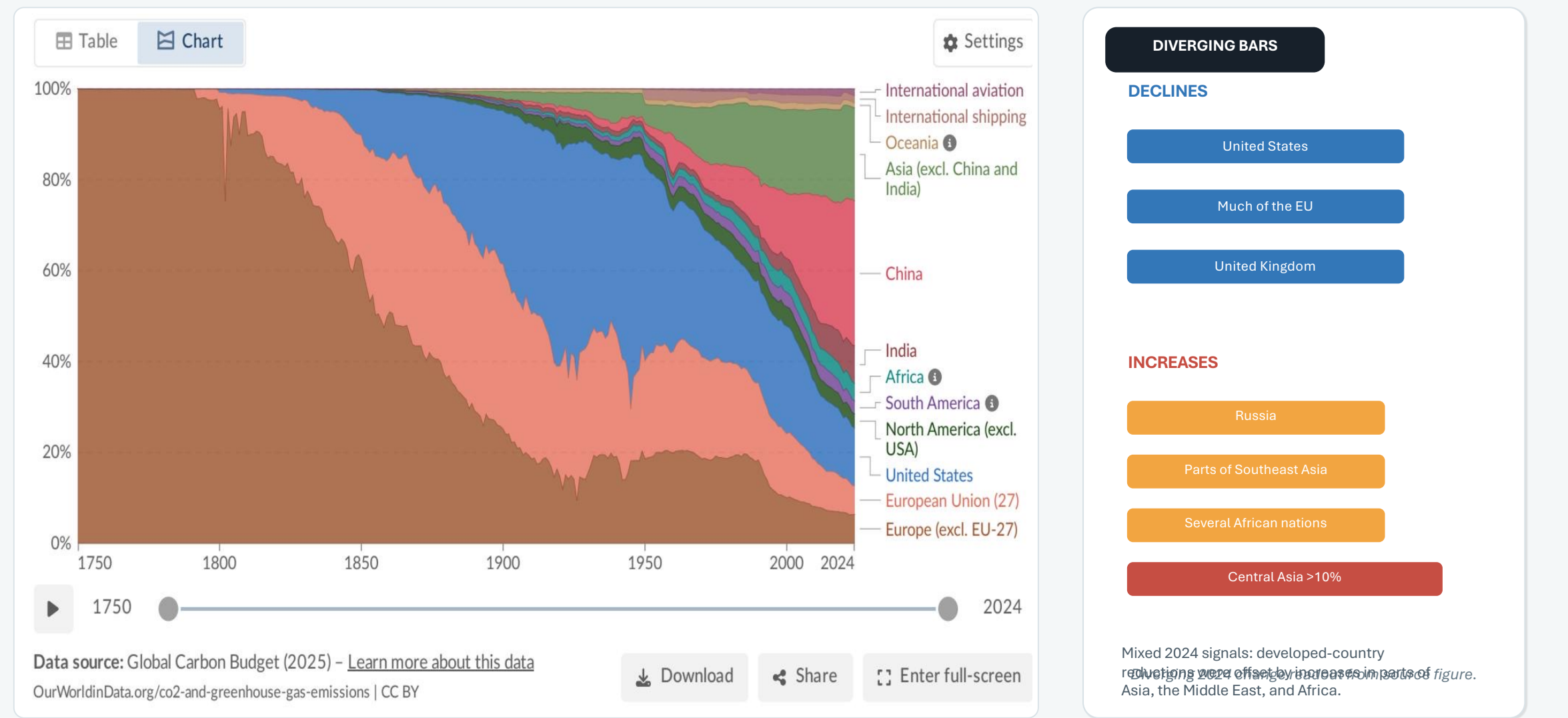
Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India



Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

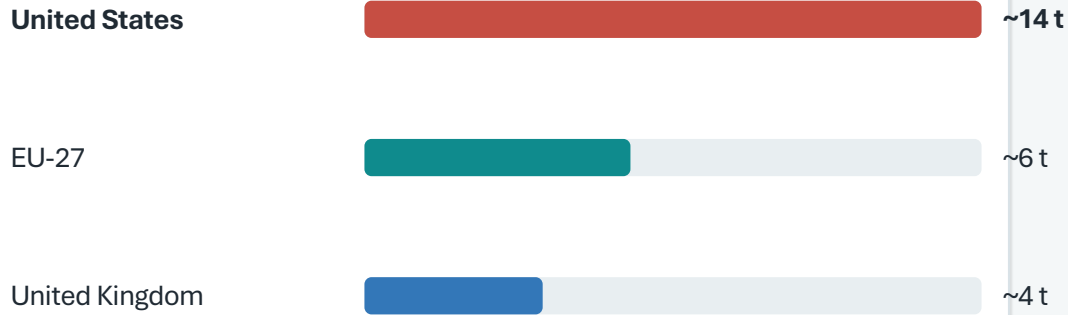
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2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia and Africa Grew



Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or the US

COMPARATIVE BAR



Comparative per-capita bars using available figures; qualitative energy-mix explanation from source brief.

Same prosperity, different emissions

- France, the UK, and Portugal have much lower per capita emissions than Germany, the Netherlands, or the US.
- The source brief attributes much of this gap to higher electricity shares from nuclear and renewable sources rather than fossil fuels.
- Energy policy and technology choices can decouple prosperity from emissions.



Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

>35 Bt/yr

Global fossil-fuel CO₂ emissions exceed 35 Bt annually and have not yet peaked.

China #1

China is the largest annual emitter; its per-capita emissions remain below the US.

History matters

Europe and the US dominated historical emissions: >90% in 1900, less than one-third today.

150x gap

Per-capita inequality persists between richest and poorest nations.

Policy lever

Energy choices can decouple prosperity from emissions.